



IMPACT PROGRAMME

**Nigeria Association of Sports Medicine
Strategic Plan 2024-2028**

AN AFFILIATE OF

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Preface

The NIGERIA ASSOCIATION OF SPORTS MEDICINE, known by its acronym “NASMED”, is an autonomous, non-political, non-religious, non-racial and non-profit-making association. The Association's secretariat is domiciled in FCT, and the Liaison office is in Lagos State.

NASMED vision is to use evidence-based medical and scientific knowledge to improve athletic performance and provide comprehensive medical care across the broad spectrum of recreational and professional athletes. It primarily affiliates with the Nigerian Olympic Committee (NOC), the International Federation of Sports Medicine (FIMS), the African Union of Sports Medicine and other regional, continental and international organisations dedicated to improving sports through medicine and related fields of science. The Association is a Multidisciplinary body for sports medicine, sports science, and physical activity.

NASMED developed a multi-year strategic plan to reposition the Association and achieve its mission. This strategic plan reinforces NASMED's activities to support developing and implementing national sports medicine policies through sports and exercise medicine advocacy, education, certification, and lifelong learning. Engage in sports and exercise medicine strategy and policy formation, as well as implementation of priority projects, sports and exercise medicine research, and regulation.

The Association was founded in November 1994 as an organisation of professionals in sports medicine that have realised the need to keep abreast with global trends in athlete care; the use of sports medicine as a tool to deepen professional practice, deliver exemplary professionalism, and produce genuine development for protecting the physical/mental health, ensuring well-being, preventing doping among all who engage in sports and exercise and promote physical activity in the general population, rooted in fairness and equity. NASMED Executive Committee developed this strategic plan to align the activities of the Association with the national sports policy and IOC programmes to achieve its mission and objectives.

Executive Summary

The Nigeria Association of Sports Medicine (NASMED) is a non-governmental and not-for-profit Association, an affiliate of the Nigeria Olympic Committee, the International Federation of Sports Medicine (FIMS), Switzerland and the African Union of Sports Medicine, Egypt, whose interests are in sports and exercise medicine development. The International Federation of Sports Medicine (FIMS), Switzerland and the African Union of Sports Medicine's principal activities promote and support sports medicine and SEM activities worldwide, assisting the national associations and supporting countries in sports medicine.

Sports Medicine (or Sports and Exercise Medicine) has come a long way in Nigeria since the 1970s. The sports medicine practice and activities were coordinated under the state sports councils while domiciled in the National Sports Commission (NSC) or Sports

Ministry. At the outset, it was listed as one of the National Sports Associations, the Sports Medicine Association of Nigeria, which the Federal government solely constituted to moderate and administer the different sports disciplines at the national level. Members were usually selected based majorly on their voluntary services and professional contributions to the various sports Associations' programmes and activities, specifically looking after the health and well-being of their athletes during camping and competitions locally, as well as medical coverage at international competitions and championships.

This selection arrangement was discontinued in 1994 during the quadrennial reconstitution and selection of members of various National Sports Associations {which has now changed to National Sports Federations to align with their respective International Federations (IFs)}. The government consequently delisted the Sports Medicine Association of Nigeria (SMAN) from its sponsored Sports Associations. This development propelled the medical professionals with training and a particular interest in promoting the practice of sports medicine as a subspeciality to come together to form a distinct professional Association encompassing all areas of medicine and allied groups, including exercise and basic sciences that will promote the ethical, standardised and scientific knowledge-based sports and exercise medicine that cater for not only young and elite national athletes but also the general citizenry in term of wellness and health promotion through sport and recreational activities.

Eventually, the existing sports medicine practitioners in various fields of medicine, allied medical professionals and sports and exercise scientists came together to

brainstorm how to re-organise and get sports medicine and science to play an integral role in sports development. A constitution drafting group was set up to produce the draft constitution, adopted at its 1st General Assembly in 1994. This is the constitution that is still in existence and being reviewed. It was envisioned then that the newly established Nigeria Association of Sports Medicine (NASMED) had to be independent and self-sufficient in administering its programmes. In November 1994, the Association was registered as a non-profit Organisation by the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC) as NIGERIA ASSOCIATION OF SPORTS MEDICINE (NASMED) Incorporated.

The newly registered Association organised its first elective General Assembly and Scientific Congress, where its first set of elected officers for 1994 to 1997 was constituted and sworn in EXCO members, namely:

1. Dr. B.O Onabowale - President
2. Dr. Senbanjo - 1st Vice President
3. Dr. Adegboyega Efunkoya - 2nd Vice President
4. Dr. Nana Yesufu - 3rd Vice President
5. Dr. William Boyd - Secretary General
6. Dr. Akinwumi K. Amao - Assist Secretary General
7. Dr. T.A.A Bashorun - Treasurer
8. Dr. Made Oyeniyi - Financial Secretary
9. Mr. Olufemi Ayorinde - Publicity Secretary
10. Mallam Mohammed Soro - Assist Publicity Secretary

11. Dr. Niran Adeniji - Ex-Officio
12. Mr' Efe Useh - Ex-Officio
13. Mrs. G.A Ariyibi - Ex-Officio

The second General Assembly and Elective Congress was held in November 1977 with the following members elected into EXCO

1. Dr/ Babatunde Onabowale - President
2. Prof. Olatunde Makanju - 1st Vice President
3. Dr. Nana Yesufu - 2nd Vice President
4. Dr. Rashed Gbadamosi .- 3rd VicePresident
5. Dr. Akinwumi K. Amao Secretary General
6. Dr. AbdulKadir Mu'Azu Assistant Secretary General
7. D. T.A.A. Bashorun (late) Treasurer
8. Dr. Martin Unegbu Financial Secretary
9. Pharm. Olufemi Ayorinde Publicity Secretary
10. Mallam Mohammed Soro Asst Publicity Secretary
11. Mrs. A. Ariyibi Prin Nurs Off Ex-Officio
12. PT. Effe Useh Ex-Officio
13. Dr. Niran Adeniji Ex-Officio

It is pertinent to mention the membership of the first Board of Trustees of NASMED as an Incorporated entity:

1. Late Alhaji Raheem Adejumo Former President of NOC
2. Late Dr. Simi Johnson “ NOC Member
3. Late Justice Uche Omoh “ NOC Member

There was a period of uncoordinated and diminished activity of NASMED from around 2004 when many principal executive members relocated because of the necessity of their public official assignments. Meetings could not be held regularly, and this scenario was compounded by the sudden death of our President in early 2005. Several efforts were made to get the Association re-organised and repositioned, but they did not yield the needed traction. Two attempts were made between 2014 and 2015 to reactivate NASMED, with two meetings held at Rowe Park and attended by members around Lagos and Edo state.

It was in August 2022 that younger sports medicine enthusiasts energised the movement to act decisively, and this culminated in the creation of NASMED WhatsApp social media platforms through which both old and new prospective members galvanised their thoughts and ideas that gave a purposeful direction towards the relaunching of NASMED in June 2024 and orderly transfer of authority to new Executives that will take the Association to the next level.

The following six thematic areas have been developed to achieve the IMPACT programme are as follows:

1. Influence the development of SEM policies, guides, SOP and inclusion in relevant national policies.
2. Mobilise membership and resources for implementing NASMED programmes.

3. Prioritise establishing SEM career pathways and recognition of SEM practitioners at all levels.
4. Achieve the Objectives of NASMED with Accountability.
5. Comprehensive framework for capacity building and fellowship programmes.
6. Transparency in governance and technology to drive innovation and growth of NASMED.

In summary, lack of awareness and inadequate skills and knowledge in SEM are significant threats to implementing the national SEM policy and strategy. The Nigeria Association of Sports Medicine intends to address this challenge using the carefully outlined interventions that comprise the six thematic areas listed above.

SPORTS AND EXERCISE MEDICINE (SEM) IN NIGERIA: CURRENT STATE AND FUTURE PROSPECTS

Introduction

The International Federation of Sports Medicine has defined SEM as a field of medicine that studies the influence of exercise and sports on people of all ages to achieve prevention, therapy, and rehabilitation for individuals and athletes.¹ In Nigeria, SEM is an emerging discipline that reflects the challenges and opportunities in the country's healthcare system and sports industry. This section explores the current state of SEM in Nigeria, highlighting fundamental limitations and suggesting pathways for future development.

The current state of SEM in Nigeria

1. Healthcare Infrastructure and Specialists

The training of sports medicine specialists in Nigeria is limited, with few institutions offering comprehensive programs. For instance, the University of Lagos and the University of Ibadan provide relevant programs, but there is a notable gap in specialised training centres dedicated exclusively to SEM.² The University of Ilorin recently approved the commencement of training in SEM.

¹ McCrory P. (2006). What is sports and exercise medicine? *British journal of sports medicine*, 40(12), 955-957.

² Oluwaseun, A. A. (2020). *Sports medicine education and training in Nigeria: Current status and future directions*. *African Journal of Medicine and Medical Sciences*, 49(2), 195-203.

2. Sports Injuries and Rehabilitation

Although there is little evidence of the prevalence of sports injuries in Nigeria, some studies have shown that it is substantial.³ Injuries range from minor sprains to severe fractures and dislocations.³ However, the rehabilitation infrastructure is often inadequate. Many sports teams and athletes rely on general practitioners rather than specialists, leading to suboptimal recovery and management of sports-related injuries.⁴

3. Exercise and Public Health

Government initiatives like the National Health Policy promote physical activity to prevent non-communicable diseases. Still, the lack of widespread exercise facilities and public awareness campaigns limits the impact of these initiatives.⁵

Challenges facing Sports and Exercise Medicine in Nigeria

1. Limited Research and Funding

Funding for SEM is often insufficient, affecting both research and practical applications.⁶ Many sports organisations and healthcare institutions struggle with

³ Njoku PN, Ugwuoke AC 2023. Sport Injuries among athletes in Ideato, Imo state. International journal of human kinetics and health education vol 8, No 1.

⁴ Ezeamama, A. E., Akinbami, L. J., & Ojo, O. E. (2019). *Prevalence and management of sports injuries among athletes in Nigeria*. Journal of Sports Medicine and Physical Fitness, 59(7), 1134-1140.

⁵ Ogunlade, O., Ilesanmi, A., & Bamidele, O. (2022). *Exercise and public health in Nigeria: Challenges and opportunities*. Nigerian Journal of Clinical Practice, 25(1), 45-52.

⁶ Ekwe KK, Vaish A, Vaishya R (2024). Research Output in Orthopaedics and Sports Medicine from Nigeria and Africa - A Bibliometric Analysis. Niger Med Journal :65(2):125-131

financial constraints, hamper their ability to invest in advanced medical technologies and professional training.⁷

2. Lack of Awareness

There is a general lack of awareness about the importance of SEM among the Nigerian public. Many view sports injuries as minor issues that can be managed with basic first aid rather than conditions requiring specialised care, contributing to its limitation.²

Prospects and recommendations

1. Education and Training

To address the current gaps, expanding educational opportunities in SEM is essential. Establishing dedicated sports medicine programs and creating partnerships with international organisations could help build a more robust workforce. Additionally, integrating SEM education into medical curricula can ensure that upcoming healthcare professionals are well-versed in the discipline.⁴

2. Investing in Infrastructure

Increasing investment in sports and exercise facilities will significantly improve access to SEM services in the government and private sectors.⁵

⁷Okoye, U. G., Onwuka, A., & Eze, I. E. (2021). *Funding and resource allocation in sports and exercise medicine in Nigeria*. International Journal of Sports Science, 34(2), 89-97.

3. Promoting Public Awareness

Public health campaigns that emphasise the benefits of regular exercise and the importance of proper injury management can enhance awareness and engagement. Collaborations between the government, sports organisations, and media could help enlighten the public and increase the utilisation of SEM services.⁷

CONCLUSION

Nigeria's sports and exercise medicine (SEM) has significant potential and notable challenges. By addressing issues related to education, infrastructure, and public awareness, Nigeria can enhance its SEM capabilities and improve the health and well-being of its population.

SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats) Analysis of NASMED

INTERNAL :	STRENGTHS 1. Availability of diverse SEM skills, knowledge and Competencies among members 2. The Association comprises of medical and allied health professional categories 3. The Association's Board of Trustees comprises thought leaders in SEM.	WEAKNESSES: 1. Absence of State chapters 2. Lack of coordination of student membership across the health sciences institutions. 3. Low participation of women and younger professionals in NASMED 4. Lack of welfare programme for members 5. Weak income generation 6. Lack of professional membership categories (Fellowship) 7. Widespread apathy among SEM professionals due to low activity in the past years
EXTERNAL	OPPORTUNITIES 1. Networking within national and international SEM communities (affiliates of Nigeria Olympic Committee, UAMS and FIMS). 2. Lack of defined career pathway in the scheme of service, resulting in under-deployment of SEM professionals at all levels; 3. Federations do not have medical and scientific commissions/committees in their management structure to foster the development of sports & exercise medicine teams to handle the athletes based on sporting rules and regulations	THREATS 1. Lack of country-level policy on developing and practising Sports and Exercise Medicine (SEM). 2. Inadequate SEM infrastructure 3. Lack of SEM research grants and dearth of literature on SEM and SEM workforce requirements in Nigeria, 4. Lack of national financing mechanisms for SEM implementation and SEM education 5. Inadequate SEM educational training centres 6. Low SEM awareness and knowledge among the workforce and the citizens 7. Lack of Sports specific health care plan (health coverage) packages for athletes across all Sports at clubs, federations, State and national levels

Thematic Focus

Theme 1:

Influence the development of SEM policies, guides, SOP and inclusion in relevant national policies.

Strategic Objective

To influence the development of SEM policies.

Rationale

The National SEM policy will provide the national sporting community with another critical government initiative to promote physical activity and sports participation. It aims to increase the treatment and prevention of sports and exercise injuries and the management of sports injuries involving athletes and the general population participating in sports and recreational activities, improving their overall health and well-being.

Key Results

1. The National SEM policies, Sports Medical Services guidelines, and SOPs are developed.
2. The national SEM environment is enhanced.

Activities

1. Establish an expert panel to draft, review, and recommend SEM policies and guidelines.
2. Ongoing broad Stakeholder engagement (Design targeted stakeholder reference and working group on SEM policies, etc.).
3. Establish mechanisms for ongoing broad stakeholder engagement beyond government to involve the private sector, development partners, civil society, and citizens.
4. Conduct high-level advocacy for state and non-state actors on identified gaps. Actively advocate for developing and integrating comprehensive SEM policies, guides, and SOPs into national health and sports policies.
5. Strengthen ties with governmental bodies to ensure SEM is a priority in national health agendas.
6. Continuous advocacy, communication, and education for decision-makers on SEM policies, etc.
7. Working with relevant stakeholders, develop appropriate SEM policies, Sports Medical Services guidelines, and SOPs.
8. Publish developed policies, guides, etc., on the NASMED website.

Theme 2:

Mobilise membership and resources for implementing NASMED programmes.

Strategic Objectives

1. To increase NASMED membership, targeting a diverse range of SEM professionals.
2. To improve the SEM skills, knowledge and competencies of members.
3. To promote and conduct annual research on all aspects of SEM.
4. To promote and support the establishment of NASMED state chapters and SEM activities at the state level.
5. TO secure funding through grants, sponsorships, and partnerships to support NASMED's programmes.
6. To foster a strong community among members through regular networking events and collaborative projects.
7. To promote teamwork early among the students before becoming professionals.
8. To augment pre-service training through student participation in the Association's educational and other activities.
9. To ensure the continuance and sustenance of the Association.

Rationale

The Association must provide strong leadership in SEM advocacy, educational programs, certification and lifelong learning. This is due to the low SEM skills, knowledge and competencies among the current workforce and limited training and training centres on SEM in the country. Creating state chapters will diffuse the training and capacity-building efforts to the state-level workforce to have a national spread. The Association is repositioned as the platform for developing human resources for SEM in Nigeria.

Key Results

1. Increase in size and the right mix of technically competent SEM workforce in Nigeria at the national and state level
2. Improved awareness of SEM among the workforce and citizens
3. Improved Association's knowledge base through research and accurate dissemination of knowledge and information
4. Create an influential Association with improved performance and improved results.

Activities

1. Create and demonstrate personal value addition membership benefits for NASMED to attract new and retain old members.
2. Establish ease of registration for membership in NASMED by digitisation.

3. Develop digital and papered ICE materials on NASMED membership to increase NASMED membership, targeting a diverse range of SEM professionals.
4. Develop SEM training standards, curriculum for undergraduate and post-graduate levels with relevant institutions, continuous professional development in SEM
5. Conduct monthly and quarterly SEM training and provide short courses for workforce categories and levels.
6. Establish SEM advocacy programmes.
7. Establish state chapters of the Association.
8. Ensure the inclusion of different membership fees for the different SEM professional categories in the constitution review.
9. Ensure the inclusion of student (undergraduate and postgraduate) membership categories in the constitution review.
10. Facilitate international exchange programmes and networking for members within the sports industry.
11. Foster a strong sense of community among members through regular networking events and collaborative projects.
12. Ensure standing committee members are comprised of various professional categories in NASMED.
13. Review and explore sources of funds that align with SEM development and practice.
14. Establish innovative financing and incentive mechanisms for implementing and participating in NASMED activities.
15. Set up a NASMED investment portfolio and management structure.

Theme 3:

Prioritise establishing SEM career pathways and recognition of SEM practitioners at all levels.

Strategic Objectives

1. To create clear and structured career pathways for SEM practitioners, including opportunities for advancement and specialisation.
2. To develop certification programs to validate and enhance the skills of SEM professionals.
3. To advocate for recognising SEM professionals within the healthcare and sports sectors, ensuring they are valued and respected.

Rationale

The current workforce service scheme does not include SEM career paths. Recognition must be provided for recruiting professionals into public and private sector positions to design, implement, and maintain SEM infrastructure and facilities. The equipped SEM workforce and professionals must be retained at the national and state levels in public and private institutions for SEM development and service provision to citizens. A clear retention strategy is needed to ensure the continuous availability of SEM practitioners in Nigeria.

Key Results

1. Improved SEM adoption in Nigeria.
2. SEM's knowledgeable membership base in the association is enhanced.
3. SEM career pathway is generated.
4. SEM professionals are recognised in the public and private sectors.
5. Retention of SEM practitioners is enhanced.

Activities

1. Mainstreaming women and younger professionals' participation in NASMED.
2. Engage and consult with stakeholder references and working groups on establishing SEM career pathways.
3. Develop SEM awareness campaign strategy and roll-out.
4. Facilitate the inclusion of SEM professionals in the scheme of service at all levels.
5. Conduct high-level advocacy to ensure Federations have a medical and anti-doping commission/committee in their management structure to foster the development of sports and exercise medicine teams to handle athletes based on sporting rules and regulations.
6. Conduct high-level advocacy to ensure that SEM practitioners chair the Federation Medical and Anti-doping Commission/committee management structure, which includes NASMED members.
7. Conduct high-level advocacy to the Federal Ministry of Sports Development to ensure the Federation's management structure comprises NASMED members.
8. Facilitate developing and implementing health insurance packages for the sports industry.
9. Facilitate a PPP arrangement to establish the Nigeria Olympic Medical Center.
10. Facilitate a PPP arrangement to establish a National Sports Science and Sports Medicine Institute.
11. Conduct annual recognition and awards for individuals/organisations that support SEM growth and practice.

Theme 4:

Achieve the objectives of NASMED with accountability.

Strategic Objectives

1. Establish clear, measurable objectives aligned with NASMED's mission and vision.
2. Implement robust monitoring and evaluation systems to track progress and impact.
3. To ensure transparency through regular reporting on activities, achievements, and financials to members and stakeholders.

Rationale

Generate feedback from NASMED activities and use the reports to reprogram the administration and programmes of NASMED to deliver its objective as an association in SEM.

Key Results

1. Enhanced stewardship and accountability at all levels.
2. Improved governance of NASMED.

Activities

1. Implement robust monitoring and evaluation systems to track progress and impact.
2. Ensure transparency through regular reporting on activities, achievements, and financials to members and stakeholders.

Theme 5:

A comprehensive framework for capacity building and fellowship programmes.

Strategic Objectives

1. To offer comprehensive training programs, workshops, and seminars to build the capacity of SEM professionals.
2. To develop fellowship programs that provide advanced training, research opportunities, and professional development.
3. To establish mentorship networks to support the professional growth of emerging SEM practitioners.

Rationale

To provide and support Pre-service and In-service training in SEM and produce an adequately trained SEM workforce. A well-trained workforce is required in Nigeria to lead SEM implementation and achieve the National SEM policies.

Key Result

1. Pre-service and In-service training in SEM is established.
2. Mentorship network and Fellowship programme established.

Activity

1. Advocacy programs on establishing Pre-service and In-service training in SEM.
2. Assess the SEM readiness of stakeholders.
3. Define SEM professional practice standards.
4. Facilitate the development of a strategy for continued SEM skills and competency acquisition.
5. Design SEM skills and competencies career progression plan.
6. Develop a standard SEM competency framework and define new accreditation requirements.
7. Implement SEM accreditation requirements.
8. Identify education and training course changes.
9. Review academic programmes to include SEM professional courses.
10. Implement education and training course changes
11. Establish specialised SEM qualifications and certification track

Theme 6:

Transparency in governance and technology to drive innovation and growth of NASMED.

Strategic Objectives

1. To uphold high governance standards, ensuring transparency, accountability, and ethical conduct.
2. To leverage technology to drive innovation in SEM practices and NASMED operations.
3. To create digital platforms for member engagement, resource sharing, and continuous learning.

Rationale

Technology adoption is widespread in sports medicine and benefits performance, injury prevention, management, and organisational efficiency.

Key Results

1. Enhanced organisational efficiency at all levels.
2. Improved usage of technology in SEM practice.

Activities

1. Establish a sub-committee on Technology in SEM.
2. Promote the adoption of technology in SEM practice.
3. Digitalisation of NASMED operations at all levels.

Thematic Area 1: Influence the development of SEM policies, guides, SOP and inclusion in relevant national policies.

Key Results	Activities	Indicators	Responsibility	Year			
				1	2	3	4
1. The National SEM policies, Sports Medical Services guidelines, and SOPs are developed. 2. The national SEM environment is enhanced.	1. Establish an expert panel to draft, review, and recommend SEM policies and guidelines. 2. Ongoing broad Stakeholder engagement (Design targeted stakeholder reference and working group on SEM policies, etc.). 3. Establish mechanisms for ongoing broad stakeholder engagement beyond government to involve the private sector, development	1. No. of SEM policies developed 2. No. of SEM training institutions established. 3. No. of SEM facilities per state.	NASMED, NOC, FMDS, UAMS, FIMS, Private Sector, IOC & Partners				

	partners, civil society, and citizens. 4. Conduct high-level advocacy for state and non-state actors on identified gaps. Actively advocate for developing and integrating comprehensive SEM policies, guides, and SOPs into national health and sports policies. 5. Strengthen ties with governmental bodies to ensure SEM is a priority in national health agendas. 6. Continuous advocacy, communication, and education for decision-makers on SEM policies, etc.						
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	7. Working with relevant stakeholders, develop appropriate SEM policies, Sports Medical Services guidelines, and SOPs. 8. Publish developed policies, guides, etc., on the NASMED website.						
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Thematic Area 2: Mobilise membership and resources for implementing NASMED programmes.

Key Results	Activities	Indicators	Responsibility	Year			
				1	2	3	4
1. Increase in size and the right mix of technically competent SEM workforce in Nigeria at the national and state level 2. Improved awareness of SEM among the workforce and citizens 3. Improved Association's knowledge base through research and accurate dissemination of knowledge and information 4. Create an influential Association with	1. Create and demonstrate personal value addition membership benefits for NASMED to attract new and retain old members. 2. Establish ease of registration for membership in NASMED by digitisation. 3. Develop digital and papered ICE materials on NASMED membership to increase NASMED membership, targeting a diverse range of SEM professionals.	1. No. of SEM professionals in Nigeria by cadre by sex per state 2. No. of awareness campaigns conducted. 3. No. of Research conducted by NASMED. 4. No. of Research output published. 5. No. of State chapters established. 6. No. of partnerships established. 7. No. of scholarships facilitated for members.	NASMED, NOC, FMDS, UAMS, FIMS, Private Sector, IOC & Partners				

improved performance and improved results.	4. Develop SEM training standards, curriculum for undergraduate and post-graduate levels with relevant institutions, continuous professional development in SEM 5. Conduct monthly and quarterly SEM training and provide short courses for workforce categories and levels. 6. Establish SEM advocacy programmes. 7. Establish state chapters of the Association. 8. Ensure the inclusion of different						
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	membership fees for the different SEM professional categories in the constitution review. 9. Ensure the inclusion of student (undergraduate and postgraduate) membership categories in the constitution review. 10. Facilitate international exchange programmes and networking for members within the sports industry. 11. Foster a strong sense of community among members through regular networking events and collaborative projects. 12. Ensure standing						
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	committee members are comprised of various professional categories in NASMED. 13. Review and explore sources of funds that align with SEM development and practice. 14. Establish innovative financing and incentive mechanisms for implementing and participating in NASMED activities. 15. Set up a NASMED investment portfolio and management structure.						
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Thematic Area 3: Prioritise establishing SEM career pathways and recognition of SEM practitioners at all levels.

Key Results	Activities	Indicators	Responsibility	Year			
				1	2	3	4
1. Improved SEM adoption in Nigeria. 2. SEM's knowledgeable membership base in the association is enhanced. 3. SEM career pathway is generated. 4. SEM professionals are recognised in the public and private sectors. 5. Retention of SEM practitioners is enhanced.	1. Mainstreaming women and younger professionals' participation in NASMED. 2. Engage and consult with stakeholder references and working groups on establishing SEM career pathways. 3. Develop SEM awareness campaign strategy and roll-out. 4. Facilitate the inclusion of SEM professionals in the scheme of service at all levels. 5. Conduct high-level advocacy to ensure Federations have a medical and anti-doping commission/committee in their management	1. No. of technically competent human resources for SEM available to practice in Nigeria 2. No. of SEM Technical Skills and knowledge areas covered by the training. 3. SEM Career pathway established 4. No. of SEM professionals recognised. 5. SEM practitioner's retention rate per cadre per institution.	NASMED, NOC, FMDS, UAMS, FIMS, Private Sector, IOC & Partners				

	structure to foster the development of sports and exercise medicine teams to handle athletes based on sporting rules and regulations. 6. Conduct high-level advocacy to ensure that SEM practitioners chair the Federation Medical and Anti-doping Commission/committee management structure, which includes NASMED members. 7. Conduct high-level advocacy to the Federal Ministry of Sports Development to ensure the Federation's management structure comprises NASMED members. 8. Facilitate developing and implementing health insurance packages for the sports industry.						
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	9. Facilitate a PPP arrangement to establish the Nigeria Olympic Medical Center. 10. Facilitate a PPP arrangement to establish a National Sports Science and Sports Medicine Institute. 11. Conduct annual recognition and awards for individuals/organisations that support SEM growth and practice.						
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Thematic Area 4: Achieve the objectives of NASMED with accountability.

Key Results	Activities	Indicators	Responsibility	Year			
				1	2	3	4
1. Enhanced stewardship and accountability at all levels. 2. Improved governance of NASMED.	1. Implement robust monitoring and evaluation systems to track progress and impact. 2. Ensure transparency through regular reporting on activities, achievements, and financials to members and stakeholders.	1. NASMED Monitoring and evaluation framework established. 2. No. of Reports on EXCO and NASMED activities per year.	NASMED, NOC, FMDS, UAMS, FIMS, Private Sector, IOC & Partners				

Thematic Area 5: A comprehensive framework for capacity building and fellowship programmes.

Key Results	Activities	Indicators	Responsibility	Year			
				1	2	3	4
1. Pre-service and In-service training in SEM is established. 2. Mentorship network and Fellowship programme established.	1. Advocacy programs on establishing Pre-service and In-service training in SEM. 2. Assess the SEM readiness of stakeholders. 3. Define SEM professional practice standards. 4. Facilitate the development of a strategy for continued SEM skills and competency acquisition. 5. Design SEM skills and competencies career progression plan.	1. No. of Pre-service training conducted per year. 2. No. of In-service training conducted per year. 3. No. of Mentees and mentors enrolled in the NASMED. 4. NASMED Fellowship established.	NASMED, NOC, FMDS, UAMS, FIMS, Private Sector, IOC & Partners				

	6. Develop a standard SEM competency framework and define new accreditation requirements. 7. Implement SEM accreditation requirements. 8. Identify education and training course changes. 9. Review academic programmes to include SEM professional courses. 10. Implement education and training course changes 11. Establish specialised SEM qualifications and certification track						
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Thematic Area 6: Transparency in governance and technology to drive innovation and growth of NASMED.

Key Results	Activities	Indicators	Responsibility	Year			
				1	2	3	4
1. Enhanced organisational efficiency at all levels. 2. Improved usage of technology in SEM practice.	1. Establish a sub-committee on Technology in SEM. 2. Promote the adoption of technology in SEM practice. 3. Digitalisation of NASMED operations at all levels.	1. Technology in SEM Standing Committee established. 2. No. of SEM facilities/practices using technology to provide services. 3. No. of SEM practitioners using technology to provide services	NASMED, NOC, FMDS, UAMS, FIMS, Private Sector, IOC & Partners				

Implementation Arrangement

Governance

To achieve this plan, the Association's National Executive Committee (EXCO) will work closely with the Standing Committees to ensure its implementation. The Marketing and Communications Committee will coordinate the mobilisation of resources and the NASMED secretariat. The Chairman of the committee is the first Vice-President of NASMED. The Standing Committees will meet every month face-to-face or electronically. The committee shall report and submit a quarterly report to the EXCO.

Financing

Financing the Association's activities is a major challenge, but with this plan, stakeholders will understand the association's work and support areas that align with their priorities for developing SEM. Financing the plan will require additional resources, but the plan will be distributed widely for donors and sponsors to review. Resources mobilized will be used strictly to implement the impact programme.

Monitoring and Evaluation

A monitoring and evaluation framework will be developed to track the implementation and ensure the results are achieved. The Key performance indicators should be monitored and reported quarterly and annually. Such reports shall be distributed widely. In years 2 and 4, a mid- and end-term strategy implementation evaluation will be conducted. These evaluations will focus on the implementation process, and the knowledge generated will be used to improve it.